5.2 Who's Who and What's What in the Bitcoin World? Identifying the Key Roles in the Network

There are three main types of participants in the ***Bitcoin*** network:

1. ***Miners*** are computers in the ***Bitcoin Network*** that *write and verify new transactions on the blockchain by appending new blocks to it*. Miners are rewarded with ***bitcoin*** for the work they do!

2. ***Nodes*** are computers in the ***Bitcoin Network*** that *store and verify* blockchain transactions and blocks. Nodes do not get rewarded for their work.

3. ***Developers*** are responsible for maintaining and proposing improvements to the ***Bitcoin*** software (ie. the code). They ensure that every computer on the network follows the rules and operates smoothly.

Overall, these three groups work together to keep the ***Bitcoin Network*** running and ensure that it remains secure and decentralized.

- **Users** are regular individuals who use ***bitcoin***. They send and receive ***bitcoin*** via their *wallets* and can also make purchases or exchange it for other currencies.
- **Exchanges** allow users to buy, sell, and trade ***bitcoin***, and facilitate transactions on the network. However, exchanges do not play a direct role in the operation of the ***Bitcoin Network*** itself.

Still a little confused? Going back to our analogy where the ***Bitcoin Network*** is like a transportation system, we will reintroduce the key players.

- **Miners** are like ***automated toll booths or bookkeepers***.

- They are responsible for the bookkeeping. They register every car that passes by and charge fees. They also verify that the cars (bitcoin transactions) passing through are not stolen, have expired license plates or are driven by unlicensed or drunk drivers.

- This process helps to ensure that the highway system (***Bitcoin Network***) is safe and efficient, and helps to prevent collisions or fraud.